ERA 19

The Cold War Turns Hot

1950 – 1954

The Korean War · the Red Scare · McCarthyism

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the Cold War lead to war abroad—and fear at home?

KEY TERMS

The Korean War · the 38th parallel · the Red Scare · the Rosenbergs · McCarthyism

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.2–8.3 · AMSCO Ch. 8.2–8.3

CONTAINMENT ON THE BATTLEFIELD

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The Korean War



- In 1950, communist North Korea invaded the South across the **38th parallel**.
- The U.S. led a UN force to defend the South—**containment** in action.
- China entered the war, and the fighting ground to a bloody stalemate.

MacArthur vs. Truman

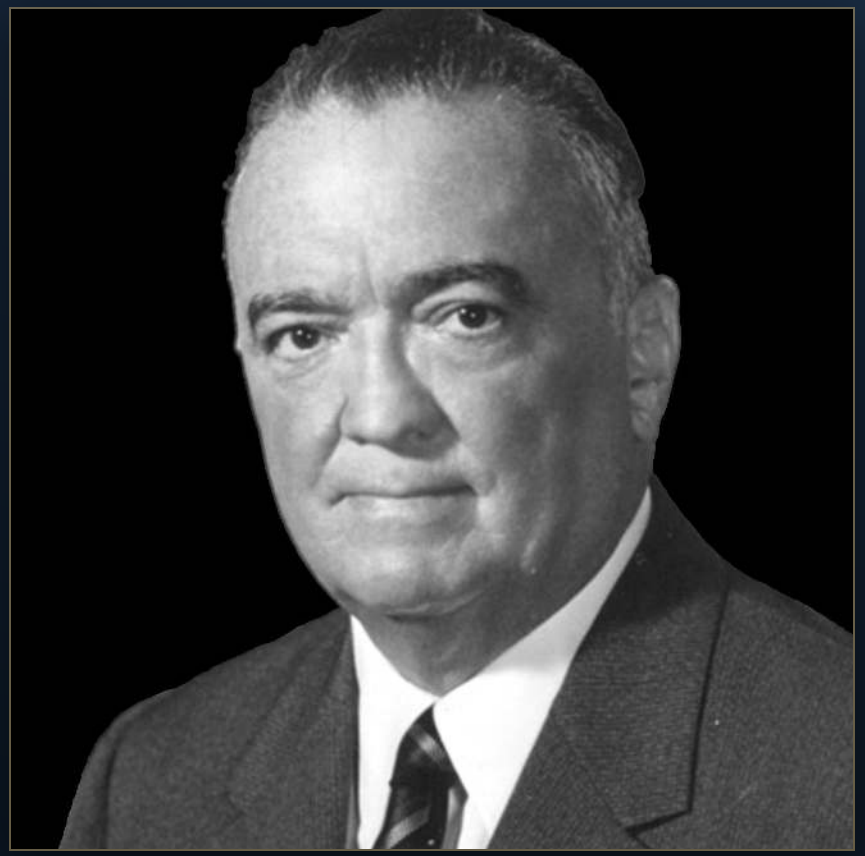
- General **MacArthur** wanted to widen the war—even into China.
- President **Truman** fired him, upholding civilian control of the military.
- An **armistice** in 1953 left Korea divided at the **38th parallel**—a **limited war**.



SECTION

The Red Scare at Home

The Hunt for Communists



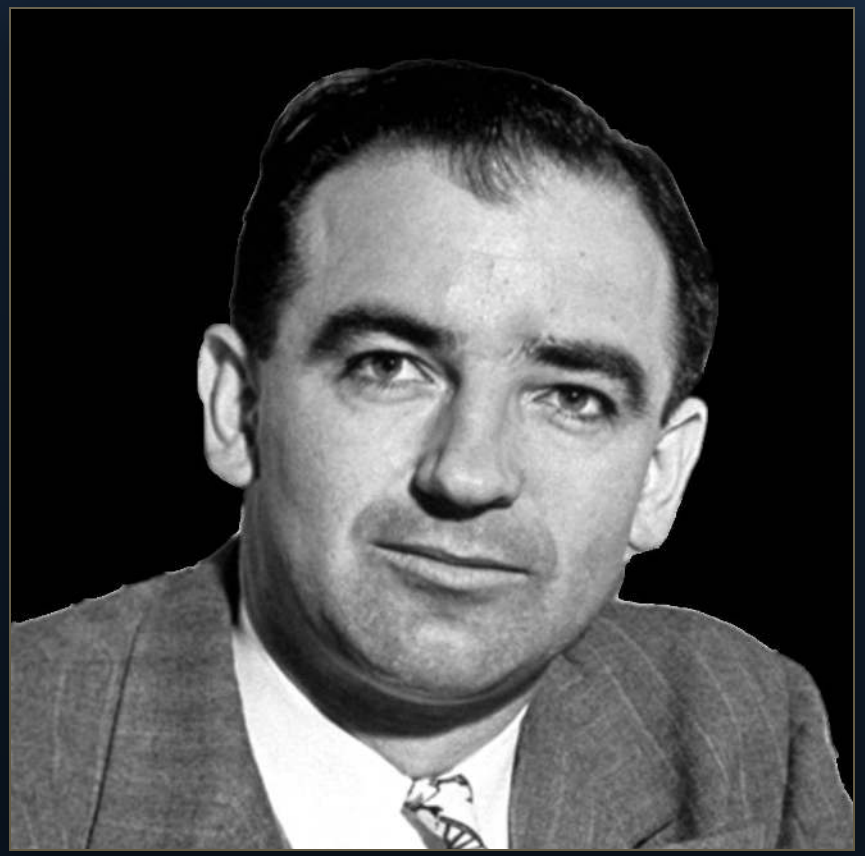
- Fear of communist infiltration gripped the nation—a second **Red Scare**.
- **HUAC** investigated Hollywood, creating a **blacklist**.
- **J. Edgar Hoover's** FBI and federal **loyalty programs** hunted suspected radicals.

Spies & Trials

- **Alger Hiss**, accused of spying, was convicted of perjury—launching **Richard Nixon**.
- Julius and Ethel **Rosenberg** were convicted of atomic **espionage**.
- The **Rosenbergs** were executed in 1953—deepening the climate of fear.



McCarthyism



- Senator **Joseph McCarthy** claimed communists had infiltrated the government.
- He ruined reputations with reckless, unproven accusations—'**McCarthyism**.'
- The televised **Army-McCarthy hearings** exposed his bullying, and he was censured in 1954.

Fear at Home

EVENT

Hollywood Ten (1947)

Screenwriters and directors who refused to answer HUAC's questions about communist ties. They were convicted of contempt of Congress, jailed and blacklisted by the movie studios.

TERM

Lavender Scare

A campaign alongside the Red Scare that pushed thousands of gay and lesbian federal employees out of their jobs as supposed "security risks." It was formalized by Eisenhower's Executive Order 10450 (1953).

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Cold War Turns Hot

1. The **Korean War** put **containment** into action—ending in a stalemate that left Korea divided.
2. **Truman's firing of MacArthur** upheld civilian control in a new era of **limited war**.
3. At home, a second **Red Scare**—the **Rosenbergs** and **McCarthyism**—spread fear and trampled civil liberties.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Cold War Turns Hot

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the policy of **containment** led the U.S. into the **Korean War**.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did the **Red Scare** compare to the first Red Scare after World War I?

ARGUMENTATION

Did **McCarthyism** protect the nation or threaten its liberties? Make and defend a claim.

Up next — **Lesson 47: The Affluent Society** (suburbs, the boom & 1950s culture)